



Are You In Suspense?

Are you wondering what happened to your order or payment, even after a fortnight? But did you mention your name and address clearly while sending payment, and what the payment was for?

We get several payments every month without adequate instructions or even identity of the person sending the payment. As a result we are unable to take appropriate action on these, till we get a complaint - if at all.

At EFY, we want you to be our satisfied customer. So please do let us know in case your payment or instructions are not even acknowledged within a fortnight. We are not that lazy!

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On June 8, 2011, Google, Facebook, Yahoo!, Akamai and Limelight Networks were among some major organisations that offered their content over IPv6 for a 24-hour 'test flight.' The goal of this Test Flight Day was to motivate organisations across the industry—Internet service providers (ISPs), hardware manufacturers, operating system vendors and Web companies—to prepare their services for IPv6 for ensuring a successful transition as IPv4 addresses run out.

India will start using IPv6 from March 2012, according to a new roadmap released by the Indian government. All telecom companies and ISPs will have to be IPv6-compliant by the end of next year, and offer IPv6 services thereafter. Federal and state government ministries, departments and public sector companies will switch over to IPv6 services by March 2012.

So what do I do?

It is imperative for any organisation to be IPv6-ready in order to remain competitive. The first step is to assess where your organisation stands in relation to IPv6. If your website is hosted by an ISP, ask its customer support personnel the following questions:

1. Do you currently provide IPv6 connectivity?
2. If not, when do you plan to deploy IPv6 on your customer networks? What is your deployment time-line?
3. When will my website be available over IPv6? What extra cost will that entail?
4. Do you provide customers with IPv6-compatible modems or other devices necessary for connecting over IPv6?
5. Why have you not provided us any information on IPv6 that would help us put in place all that's needed from our side to be ready for IPv6 compliance?

Next, carry out an audit of your entire IT infrastructure, and identify the hardware/software that needs to be changed or upgraded. For your hardware (routers, servers, etc), get in touch with the original equipment

manufacturer (OEM) or vendor to check for IPv6 compliance. Ensure that all the equipment is dual-stacked (running both IPv4 and IPv6). If the hardware does not support IPv6, find out from the OEM whether a replacement is required, or if an upgrade/patch will suffice.

For software purchased from a third party, get in touch with the provider to check if the product is already IPv6 compatible or if there's an upgrade available. If no IPv6 upgrade is available look for an alternative software source. Any software that has been developed in-house may have to be rewritten. Identify and change all hard-coded IPv4 addresses in software code to IPv6. Any application that directly uses network sockets or other network-related programming might have to be re-written. Most operating systems are IPv6 compatible—IPv6 support is inbuilt and you only need to activate it. However, identify any legacy systems running an operating system (OS) without IPv6 support, and either replace these, or patch/upgrade the OS.

I use FOSS; am I affected?

IPv6 migration is an issue that affects everyone. It is not restricted to only particular hardware or software. The problem is independent of the technology or software you use, as it stems from a core flaw in the transmission control protocol/IP addressing scheme. So yes, people using Open Source operating systems and applications could also be affected.

Linux and IPv6

The first IPv6-related network code was added to the Linux kernel 2.1.8 in November 1996 by Pedro Roque. In most Linux configurations these days, IPv6 is active by default and the required IPv6 kernel modules are loaded automatically. To check whether your current running kernel supports IPv6, look in your '/proc' file-system for the pseudo-file '/proc/net/if_inet6.' If this entry is not present, you can try